

Flash memory, it is also referred to as solid-state memory.

There are several advantages of using Flash memory. Apart from offering better shock resistance as compared to hard drives, flash memory is noiseless, offers fast access, and is much smaller and lighter. However, the downsides are that the cost per MB of Flash memory is much higher than that of hard drives, and the capacities available still do not match those available on the latter.

Different types of Flash memory cards are available in different capacities for removable storage applications. The type of memory card you need to use is dictated by the device you wish to use it with. Most of these cards are physically different from one another and are not interchangeable. Some flash card formats include CompactFlash Type I & II (CF), Microdrive (MD), Memory Stick (MS), MagicGate (MG), SmartMedia (SM),

Types of Flash Cards

Name	Acronym	Form factor
CompactFlash I	CF-I	43 × 36 × 3.3 mm
CompactFlash II	CF-II	43 × 36 × 5.5 mm
SmartMedia Card	SMC	45 × 37 × 0.76 mm
Memory Stick	MS	50.0 × 21.5 × 2.8 mm
Memory Stick Duo	MS Duo	31.0 × 20.0 × 1.6 mm
Memory Stick Micro	M2	15.0 × 12.5 × 1.2 mm
MultiMediaCard	MMC	32 × 24 × 1.5 mm
Reduced Size MultiMediaCard	RS-MMC	16 × 24 × 1.5 mm
MMCmicro Card	MMCMicro	12 × 14 × 1.1 mm
Secure Digital Card	SD	32 × 24 × 2.1 mm
miniSD Card	miniSD	21.5 × 20 × 1.4 mm
microSD Card	μSD	11 × 15 × 1 mm
xD-Picture Card	xD	20 × 25 × 1.7 mm